

[Finance Workbench]

EVERY FIGURE IN YOUR CLOSE, OPENED TO THE ROWS THAT MADE IT

AI takes the repetition. Finance keeps the judgement.

Finance keeps the judgement, the approvals and the accountability. What a model can take is everything between the ledger and the pack — the part that produces the same answer a different way every month.

THE PROBLEM

The ledger closes. The insight still starts in Excel.

AI reads governed numbers in place — and names the movement, driver and evidence.

Management gets one discussion: what happened, why, what next and who owns it.

Finance has the transactions. The insight is still manual.

The accounting system records what happened; everything after that is a person. Teams export to Excel, rebuild the model, rebuild the pack and write the commentary again — and every question from a board starts the cycle over.

THE PROBLEM

Ledgers close

Five entities, four currencies. The accounting systems have every transaction, and this part is finished.

Export

Out to Excel, because nothing above the ledger can read it in place.

Rebuild

The model, the mappings, the drivers — reconstructed rather than refreshed, by whoever is available.

Rebuild again

The pack, and the commentary explaining it. Written from scratch every month.

The questions

The board asks what drove the result, what would improve it and what management should act on — and the whole cycle starts over to answer it.

Twelve times a year, the same work. None of this is a failure of the ledger — it is everything after the ledger, which no accounting system was built to do: naming what drove the result, and flagging the strengths, weaknesses, risks and opportunities a board should act on.

Keep the ERP. The gap is the layer above it.

What makes this a 2026 conversation rather than a 2022 one: a model can now draft the board commentary against a governed set of numbers and cite every figure in it back to a ledger row.

WHY NOW

Judgement

Whether the numbers are right, what to do about them, and the sign-off. A person, every month.

YOURS, BY DESIGN

The finance layer

A governed model of P&L, balance sheet, cash and KPIs — and the variance, bridge, scenario and board commentary built on it, every figure resolving to the rows that made it.

MISSING · THIS IS THE WORKBENCH

Automation

OCR and workflow handle AP and AR. BI draws the dashboards. Planning tools hold the budget.

ALREADY SOLVED

Systems of record

ERP, CRM, payroll and operations record the transactions. They stay the source of truth.

ALREADY YOURS

What comes off a person: rebuilding the model, reconciling the pack, and writing the first draft. The next three slides run this layer on a synthetic group.

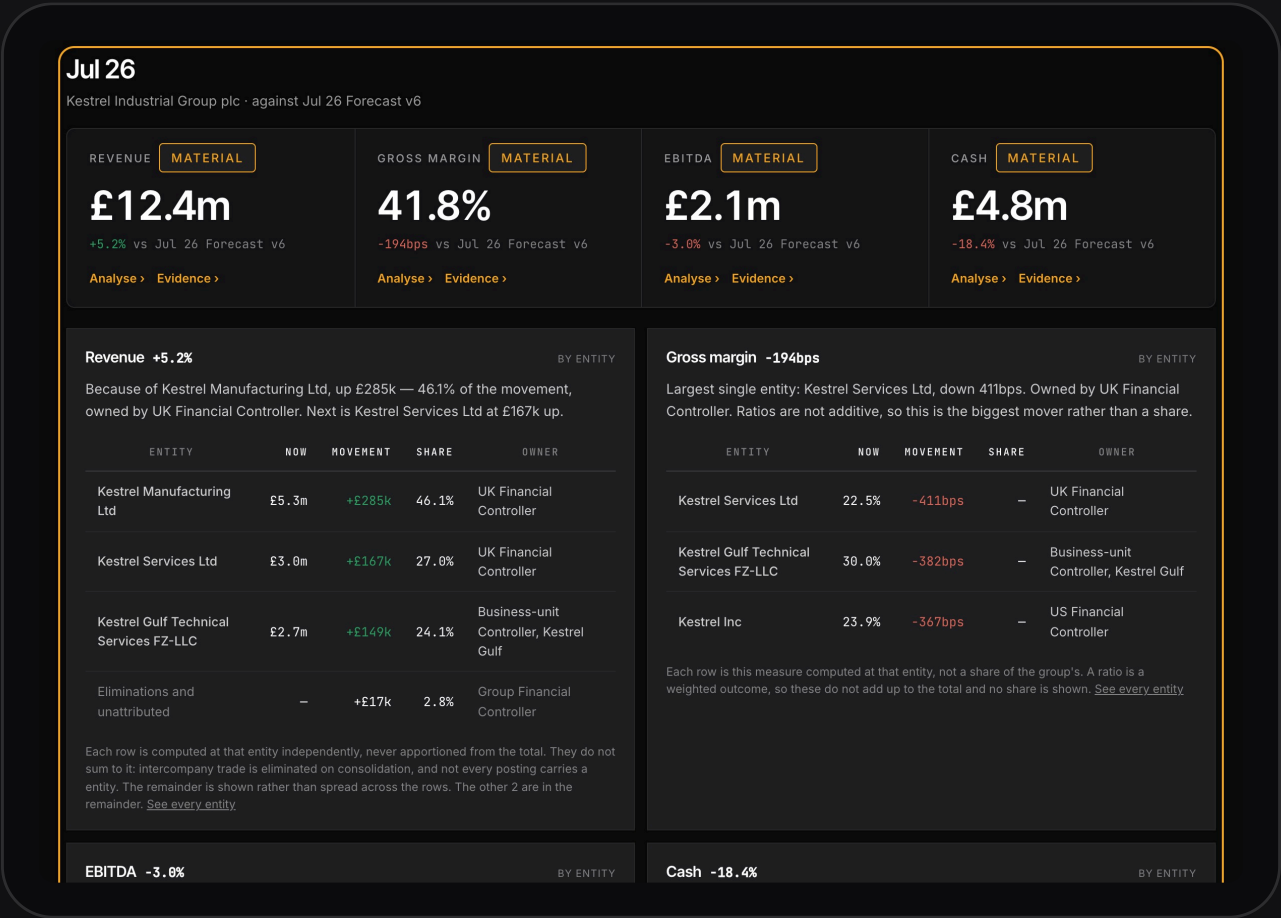
The Solution

Three live surfaces: the position, the movement behind a figure, and the ledger rows it resolves to. Twelve weeks then move them from the synthetic group onto your ledgers.

One governed close, not four spreadsheets.

July 2026 Actuals for Kestrel Industrial Group plc, against the Final Forecast Version.
What counts as material is set by a versioned policy the group financial controller owns.

THE SOLUTION



A variance is only useful once it names its cause.

Revenue: the Final Forecast Version at £11.8m to the £12.4m actual, split into drivers — volume at £582k, £83k in segments with no natural unit. Currency is split out, so no commercial bar carries translation.

OUR PRODUCT

Revenue, decomposed

Jul 26 against Jul 26 Forecast v6. Currency is separated first, so no commercial bar carries a translation effect.



The bars sum to the movement exactly — residual +£0k. The axis starts at £11.7m rather than zero, so the contributions are legible. The two terminals are drawn as level markers rather than columns, because on a truncated axis a column height is not a proportion.

The largest single component is **volume** at £582k, and within it service contracts at £335k.

Three horizons

Read together to distinguish timing from a change in run rate.

In month Jul 26

£12.4m

ACTUAL

vs Budget FY26 +£762k · +6.6%

vs Forecast v6 +£618k · +5.2%

Year to date YTD through July 2026

£90.2m

ACTUAL

vs Budget FY26 +£5.6m · +6.6%

vs Forecast v6 +£619k · +0.7%

Remaining forecast Remaining forecast · August 2026 – December 2026

£63.1m

FORECAST V6 · APPROVED

vs Budget FY26 +£670k · +1.1%

Approved basis: Forecast v6 (v6), actuals through June 2026 and projection from July 2026. Budget: Budget FY26 (budget-fy26).

£0k

unattributed — the named driver bars sum to the movement.

5

ledgers — every row has a named owner

The answer and the evidence are one object. Movement, drivers, formula, rows and source vintage hang off the figure itself. If the workbench cannot see past the ledger boundary, it says so.

Each figure drills to the rows that made it.

The revenue figure opened: the consolidated total split into its five entities, with the intercompany elimination named as its own line.

OUR PRODUCT

£12.4m

revenue, as the position states it

£11.8m

Final Forecast Version, the comparator it is read against

£618k

the difference, and every row behind it

+5.2%

against the **Final Forecast Version** as approved before the period opened

The drill carries the row, measure, period and immutable load vintage. The comparator is versioned and named on the figure; calculations use unrounded values even when the page abbreviates them. **The first readiness test is whether that comparator exists as a governed version, not a spreadsheet somebody keeps.**

[← Back to grid](#)

Revenue › 2026-07

Revenue › 2026-07

Kestrel Industrial Group plc · Actual · Jul 26 · against Jul 26 Forecast v6. A group figure breaks into its entities, each computed at its own level — so these are measurements rather than a share of the figure above. They are the *combined* total, so the intercompany elimination is named as its own line and the parts tie to the consolidated cell.

£12.4m · consolidated		
	LEVEL	
	VALUE	SHARE
Kestrel Manufacturing Ltd	£5.3m	42.5%
Kestrel Services Ltd	£3.0m	24.4%
Kestrel Gulf Technical Services FZ-LLC	£2.7m	21.7%
Kestrel Europe GmbH	£1.5m	12.4%
Kestrel Inc	£730k	5.9%
Intercompany eliminated	-£855k	-6.9%
These parts sum to the cell exactly.		

+ Technical evidence

Formula, provenance and source rows

Formula inspector

The definitions below are the same catalogue entries that compute the grid and ground Ask. Open any dataset cell for the accounts, rows and vintages used in that calculation.

A twelve-week build from your ledgers to a real close.

The first three weeks test the dependencies a schedule cannot wish away. At the gate we proceed, rescope or stop; each stage leaves behind a usable artefact, and the workbench reads your ledgers but never writes to them.

ROADMAP



WEEKS 1-3

Readiness gate

Confirm one close, its comparator, mappings, owners, approved data access, security route, tenant or jurisdiction and source interfaces. You keep the data-quality assessment and week-one baseline.



WEEKS 4-8

Build and evaluate

Reproduce a close your controllers already signed. Back-test the position, drivers and evidence on your data; name where it matches and where it does not.



WEEKS 9-11

Integrate

Connect ERP and consolidation, align permissions to entity ownership, monitor pipelines, train controllers, and deliver controls, model documentation, evaluation evidence and the runbook.



WEEK 12

Operate

Run one real month-end through the workbench. Measure it against the baseline, name production ownership and scope the surfaces that follow.

Measured in week one and week twelve: working days to a signed close · restatements after sign-off · hours rebuilding the model, pack and commentary. The threshold is agreed with you in week one because this is Deeplight's first Finance Workbench close on a client's ledgers.

The Company

Two UAE transformation case studies, the senior team accountable for the work, and the three ways an engagement starts.

Two UAE transformations. Both running in production.

One tier-1 bank and one national energy buyer, each moved from fragmented or nonexistent foundations to governed products in live operation.

Case Study 01 • Banking

60 DAYS

At ADCB, a cloud-native AWS estate and governed lakehouse cut processing from 72 hours to 15 minutes and lifted data quality from 67% to 95%.

ADCB • Production

2,000+ USERS

Governed data streams and CRM integration supported the UAE's first certified Open Finance rollout across twenty-plus systems without interrupting daily banking.

Case Study 02 • Energy

0 → 1 PLATFORM

At EWEC, a Databricks lakehouse and governed pipelines were built from zero as one data and AI platform.

EWEC • Production

3 MODELS LIVE

Demand forecasting, solar forecasting and reserve management run with live monitoring, champion/challenger comparison and drift-triggered retraining.

Senior accountability. Squad delivery.

The four leaders below own the engagement from the first conversation through live validation. Delivery scales by squad across Data, Delivery, Engineering and AI; each function is led end to end, with production ownership, runbooks and handover built into the work.

OUR TEAM



Tristan Blakley

CEO AND CO-FOUNDER

Client ambition, the delivery standard and the relationship. Founded Dreamtek and led it to its 2021 sale after delivering technology for Google and Facebook.



Terrence Kunstek

CTO AND CO-FOUNDER

Architecture, engineering quality, governance, production reliability. Two decades in engineering leadership: ChaCha, Eleven Fifty, SecondSight.



Sam Patel

CHIEF PRODUCT OFFICER

The product thesis, scope, delivery and value realisation. Over twenty years across financial services and technology.



Saniul Islam

CHIEF COMMERCIAL OFFICER

Client fit, executive alignment, commercial structure, mobilisation. Formerly programme delivery at LSEG.

Three programmes, chosen by what you already know

Each removes a different blocker: not knowing which problem to solve, not getting one solved, or not having the seniority to run the programme you have already committed to.

HOW WE WORK

01

Discovery

Stop funding the wrong thing. In eight weeks, we deliver an AI strategy, a value-ranked use-case roadmap and a governance framework — so the build budget goes to a problem worth solving.

EIGHT WEEKS · WHEN THE ROADMAP DOES NOT
EXIST YET

02

Accelerate

Get one model into production. In twelve weeks at a fixed price, it is integrated with your systems, validated on your data and handed over with risk-ready documentation. Finance Workbench follows this route.

FROM \$185K · GATE OUTCOME: PROCEED, RESCOPE
OR STOP

03

People

Add seniority where programmes fail. Product, data, AI and engineering leadership inside a programme you already run — accountable to outcomes and scaling by squad.

TIME AND MATERIALS · WHEN THE PROGRAMME
ALREADY EXISTS

Bring one problem. Leave with a written verdict.

We test value, production readiness and delivery route — then tell you whether to proceed, rescope or stop.

THE ASK

THE FIT CALL

30

MINUTES

01	VALUE	What outcome matters, who owns it, and what proves success?
02	READINESS	Can the workflow, data and controls carry a production product?
03	ROUTE	Which delivery route gets it moving with the least waste?

YOU LEAVE WITH

Fit verdict · recommended route · first scope · success measure · next step

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